Editorial Tips
NLP Course, Winter 2026/27

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Template: Anna Wróblewska (Warsaw University of Technology), adapted from the ACL 2015 conference formatting template.

Abstract

This document collects the formatting and editorial rules for NLP-course reports. Read it once, then use it as a checklist before every submission.

1 What stays the same across all phases

1.1 Layout and fonts

Two columns, 11pt Times (already set by `acl2015.sty` and `\usepackage{times}` above – do not change the class options). Keep section headings numbered (Arabic numerals); do not number subsubsections. A4 page size is handled by the style file.

1.2 Citations

Use `\cite{key}` for parenthetical citations and `\shortcite{key}` or `\newcite{key}` for "Author (Year)" in running text, exactly as in the original ACL macros. Two graded rules from the criteria document govern *which* papers you cite, not just how:

- Preferred venues: ACL, EMNLP, NAACL, or ACM Computing Surveys (aclanthology.org).
- Cite the published version of a work whenever one exists; preprint-only citations (arXiv with no venue) should be under one third of your bibliography. The final-report template additionally excludes arXiv preprints from "well-justified literature" unless the work is too recent to have a published version yet.

1.3 Language

Scientific, precise language; no unexplained abbreviations on first use. Every figure and table caption must be understandable without reading the surrounding text – a reader skimming only captions should still follow the story.

1.4 Reproducibility

Seeds, library versions, and the exact command(s) used to produce your main reported result must be stated somewhere in the report or its appendix. Use `reproducibility-checklist.tex` as the appendix template – it is graded as part of Phase 3.

2 What differs by phase

- **Phase 1 (proposal)**: max. 4 meaningful pages. Template: `project-proposal.tex`.
- **Phase 3 (final report)**: about 9 pages, max 12, plus the reproducibility appendix. Template: `project-final-report-structure.tex`.

Do not carry one phase's page limit over to another – this has been a recurring point of confusion.

3 Mandatory content, every phase

Three items are conditions of acceptance, not scored criteria: a report missing any of them is not graded at all until it is added, in every phase where it applies.

- **Contribution table** – each team member, what they did, workload in hours. Required from Phase 2 onward.
- **Declaration of LLM use** – which tools, for what.
- **Data statement** – source of the data, licence, whether it contains personal data, and what you do about it.

4 Submission mechanics

- **Folder naming**: every milestone goes in a folder named `surname_surname_surname_surname` (all team members). The order set at the first submission must not change for the rest of the semester – a mismatch costs 5 points.
- **Format**: PDF compiled from these LaTeX templates, or the Word equivalent if you were told to use one. **Wrong template:** -5 **points**, and you resubmit in the correct one.
- **Late submission**: one delay of up to 48 hours per semester carries no penalty. Every further delay costs 5 points per started week of that phase.